

Ali Vincent Al-Azem

Research Engineer

+1 (951) 972-6031
avalazem@gmail.com
alialazem.github.io
in alialazem

Research Interests Applied data analysis and modeling, machine learning, cognition, computational linguistics, dynamical systems

Education

2023–2024 **M1 Mathématiques et Applications**, Sorbonne Université, Paris
2019–2021 **B.Sc. Mathematics**, University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA), Los Angeles

Research

Jun 2025– **Co-Author**, École Normale Supérieure, Paris
Nov 2025 Created a data pipeline using the IPA-CHILDES database to analyze syllable composition and frequency across 31 languages, investigating the role of syllable structure in early language acquisition.
Nov 2024– **Research Intern**, Laboratoire de Sciences Cognitives et Psycholinguistique, Paris
May 2025 Designed an fMRI paradigm to investigate neural mechanisms of word processing.
Conducted fMRI acquisition at NeuroSpin and developed preprocessing and analysis pipelines using Nilearn. Collaborated on training RNNs on phonetic data to simulate human word repetition.
Jul 2022– **Undergraduate Researcher**, University of California, Los Angeles, Los Angeles
Aug 2022 Studied the effects of generalized alcohol use on memory recall as part of a large-scale meta-analysis
Sequenced mitochondrial DNA using PCR and analyzed sequences with BLAST to study haplogroup distributions and human migration patterns

Under Preparation

- [1] K. J. Tey, S. Peperkamp, M. Cychosz, **A. Al-Azem**, and A. Cristia. *Towards a Scalar Approach to Syllable Complexity Classification for Predicting Cross-linguistic Variation in Vocal Development*. 2025.

Invited Talks

- [2] K. J. Tey and **A. Al-Azem**. “The Relationship Between Phonological Complexity and Canonical Proportion: Cross-linguistic Analysis of Naturalistic Recordings Using Automated Methods”. Invited research presentation at Stanford University, Stanford, CA, USA. Nov. 2025.

Teaching

Feb 2017– **Supplemental Instructor**, Riverside City College, Riverside
Jun 2017 Tutored students and held supplemental group classroom sessions in statistics.

Skills & Interests

Programming Python, C/C++, Git, pandas, pytorch, scikit-learn, SQL
Languages English (native), French (C1), Spanish (beginner)
Interests Climate Change and Energy Transition, Languages, Hiking, Cooking

References

Yair Lakretz (P.I.)

Laboratoire de Sciences Cognitives et Psycholinguistique
Paris Artificial Intelligence Research Institute
Paris

✉ yair.lakretz@gmail.com

🌐 <https://yairlak.github.io>

Alejandrina Cristia (P.I., co-author)

Département d'études cognitives
École Normale Supérieure
Paris

✉ alejandrina.cristia@ens.fr

🌐 <https://sites.google.com/site/acrsta>

Christophe Pallier (Collaborator)

INSERM-CEA Cognitive Neuroimaging Unit
Neurospin

Gif-sur-Yvette

✉ christophe@pallier.org

🌐 <https://pallier.org>

Kai Jia Tey (co-author)

Laboratoire de Sciences Cognitives et Psycholinguistique

Paris

✉ kaijiatey@gmail.com